

Task for Alex Lucchini

You need to use Wayback Machine to search for the websites of the accelerators provided in the Excel file “List of accelerators_RA.xlsx” with the end goal of retrieving the web pages (i.e., storing the HTML code) of the cohorts run by these accelerators.

Each accelerator has run multiple (i.e., more than or equal to 2) cohorts, with (ideally) different dates. For each accelerator and for each different date, you need to retrieve the HTML code of the website concerning the accelerator’s cohort, which will then be analyzed using LLMs to retrieve information on the accelerator’s cohort (e.g., duration, funding, etc.). Typically, all of the accelerator’s website will be focused on the cohort in the specific period of time preceding it: accelerators are small-to-medium organizations, devoted to highlighting and promoting their new cohorts on their websites.

You will need to extract snapshots for the month of the acceleration (i.e., when the acceleration has started; variable: `acceleration_date`). In case there is no snapshot for the month of the acceleration, extract the first available snapshot proceeding backward from the acceleration month.

In case an accelerator has run different cohorts simultaneously, you will need to leverage the name and the location of the cohort to disentangle data on each of the simultaneous cohorts (i.e., use variables `cohort_name` and `location`).

Data that needs to be extracted via LLMs:

- Duration of the acceleration period, typically in weeks or months
- Funding provided by the accelerator to selected start-ups, typically from some thousands up to several hundreds of thousands of dollars
- Equity taken by the accelerator: this may vary, with accelerators that do not take any equity to accelerators that take up to 12/15%
- Mentorship provided by mentors or employees of the accelerator program
- Demo days, which are events that take place at the end of the acceleration period and are organized to give start-ups the opportunity to pitch their business ideas in front of a crowd of interested people (e.g., business angels, venture capitalists, corporations, etc.)
- Verticalist, namely whether the accelerator’s cohort – or, more generally, the accelerator – has a specific focus in terms of industry or vertical